Analytical Paragraph

The big idea

An **analytical paragraph** (about **100–120 words**, 5 marks) describes and interprets information given as a **chart, graph, table or cue points**. You do not give your personal opinion; you **present the facts clearly, compare them and draw a conclusion** from the data.

Structure

ANALYTICAL PARAGRAPH TEMPLATE

1. **Title** (optional but useful): e.g. *Growth of Internet Users in India (2015–2023)*
2. **Introduction (1–2 sentences):** what the chart shows, the period and the units. *The bar graph illustrates the number of… between… and…*
3. **Body (3–5 sentences):** the **overall trend**, the **highest and lowest** values, **comparisons** and any **sudden change**, with exact figures.
4. **Conclusion (1–2 sentences):** summarise the main trend or a reasonable inference from the data.

Useful vocabulary

Purpose	Words and phrases
Introduce	The graph/chart/table **depicts, illustrates, shows, presents, compares**

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Rise	rose, increased, grew, climbed, surged, soared, a sharp/steady/gradual rise
Fall	fell, declined, dropped, decreased, plunged, a significant/slight decline
No change	remained stable/constant, levelled off, plateaued
Up and down	fluctuated
Peak/low	reached a peak of, hit a low of
Compare	while, whereas, in contrast, compared to, twice as many as, the same as
Proportion	a quarter, one-third, nearly half, the majority, a small minority
Conclude	Overall, In conclusion, It is evident that, The data clearly indicate

DON'T LIST EVERY NUMBER

Group the data and pick out the **key features**. A paragraph that just reads out every bar like a list loses marks for analysis.

KEEP TENSES CONSISTENT

Use the **past tense** for completed periods (*rose from 20% in 2015 to 45% in 2020*) and the **present** for what the chart shows (*The graph shows…*). Avoid personal opinions like *I think*.

MODEL ANALYTICAL PARAGRAPH

Question: The bar graph shows the percentage of students in a school using different modes of transport in 2023: school bus 40%, cycle 25%, private car 20%, walking 10%, public transport 5%.

Answer — Modes of Transport Used by Students (2023)

The bar graph illustrates the percentage of students of a school using various modes of transport in 2023. The **school bus** was clearly the most popular choice, used by **40%** of students. **Cycling** came second at **25%**, followed by **private cars** at **20%**. In contrast, only **10%** of students **walked** to school, and **public transport** was the least preferred, at a mere **5%**. Thus, eco-friendly modes like cycling and walking together accounted for over one-third of students. Overall, it is evident that most students rely on the school bus, and there is scope to encourage more students to cycle or use public transport.

DESCRIBING A LINE GRAPH (TREND SENTENCES)

*Sales of electric scooters **rose steadily** from 2,000 units in 2019 to 8,000 in 2021, **surged** to 20,000 in 2022 and then **levelled off** in 2023.*

*The literacy rate in the state **increased from 60% to 78%** over two decades — a **rise of 18 percentage points**.*

SCORING CHECKLIST

Clear introduction naming the chart and period ✓ · Overall trend ✓ · Highest and lowest with figures ✓ · Comparisons using linkers ✓ · Logical conclusion ✓ · No opinions ✓ · 100–120 words ✓

Quick recap

- Introduce → trend and key figures → comparisons → conclusion.
- Use trend verbs (rose, declined, fluctuated, peaked) and linkers (whereas, in contrast).
- Be factual and selective; don't copy every number; no "I think".

Practice questions

1. An analytical paragraph mainly

   (a) gives personal opinions (b) describes and interprets data from a chart or graph (c) narrates a story (d) persuades the reader to buy a product

2. Which is the best opening sentence?

   (a) I think the graph is very interesting. (b) Look at this chart carefully. (c) The line graph shows the number of tourists visiting Goa from 2018 to 2023. (d) Tourists love Goa.

3. Which word describes values that go up and down repeatedly?

   (a) Plateaued (b) Soared (c) Fluctuated (d) Plunged

4. Which linker is used to show contrast?

   (a) Moreover (b) Furthermore (c) Similarly (d) Whereas

5. What should the conclusion of an analytical paragraph contain?

   (a) A new set of numbers not in the chart (b) A story about the topic (c) A summary of the main trend or a logical inference from the data (d) A list of all the figures again

6. What is the usual word limit for an analytical paragraph in the board exam?

   (a) 100–120 words (b) 30–40 words (c) 250–300 words (d) 500 words

7. "Sales remained at 500 units from 2020 to 2022" can best be rewritten as

   (a) Sales soared between 2020 and 2022. (b) Sales plunged between 2020 and 2022. (c) Sales remained stable at 500 units between 2020 and 2022. (d) Sales fluctuated sharply between 2020 and 2022.

8. The table shows the average daily screen time of Class 10 students: 2019 — 2 hours, 2020 — 5 hours, 2021 — 6 hours, 2022 — 4 hours, 2023 — 3.5 hours. Write an analytical paragraph (100–120 words).

Answers: 1. b 2. c 3. c 4. d 5. c 6. a 7. c 8. see notes